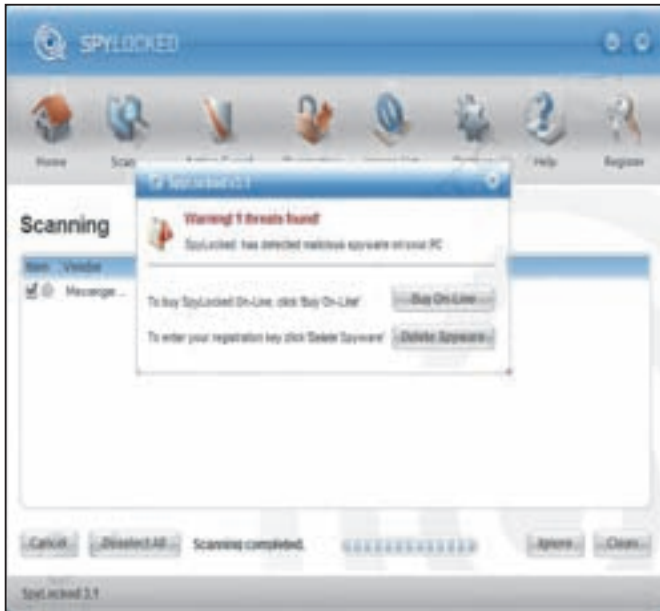




Beware of "rogue" anti-spyware programs that contain infections

Finally, spyware can be delivered via viruses and worms as payload. For example, the Spybot worm causes several pornographic pop-ups to appear on the user's screen. This directs traffic and channels funds to the spyware authors.

The most common effect of spyware is the incidence of pop up ads. These are advertisements that appear in a separate window of the browser without the active consent of the user. They are the result of the spyware gathering info on the user. This feedback results in ads specifically targetted at the user depending on the sites browsed. Rootkits are newer and more powerful types of spyware. They can hide inside system critical processes such as Safe Mode, and are harder to detect since they leave no on-disk signatures. Newer spyware programs have countermeasures against anti-malware programs, such as preventing installation/execution of the same and even uninstalling them. Gromozon is one such malware